

1. What did you learn that you did not know before?

Before this assignment, I barely know anything about Cloudflare other than having seen their logo somewhere. Now I understand that it also acts as an authoritative DNS provider, runs an anycast edge network, and works as a reverse proxy with caching in front of many origin servers.

2. What was the most challenging part of this assignment?

The hardest part was turning my personal outage experience into a precise technical explanation using DNS, anycast, and caching concepts from the textbook. It was also challenging to decide which Cloudflare features to keep and which ones to drop so that everything still fits within four pages.

3. How did GenAI help or hinder your understanding?

GenAI helped me organise the structure of the report and suggested clearer wording when my own sentences were vague. And I also use GenAI to help me reduce my paragraphs' lengths to fit the page limit while maintaining all key informations.

4. What steps did you take to verify GenAI-generated information?

For each important claim, I checked Cloudflare's official documentation and the Kurose–Ross textbook to see if it matched.

5. What would you do differently next time?

Next time I would first draw diagrams and write my own rough explanation, and only then ask GenAI to refine the text. I would also track sources from the beginning so that adding citations at the end becomes easier. I would also start the assignment earlier.